Indira Gandhi's Emergency. In a book entitled *Last Days of Jawaharlal Nehru*, published in 1977, Kamath took his readers back to a Parliament session in September 1963, when he saw 'an old man, looking frail and fatigued, with a marked stoop in his gait, coming down the gangway opposite with slow, faltering steps, and clutching the backrests of benches for support as he descended'. The man was Jawaharlal Nehru, prime minister of India at this time for the past sixteen years.

As H.V. Kamath watched 'the bent, retreating figure', a cluster of memories came to his mind. Was this the same man who, while Kamath was studying at the Presidency College in Madras, he had seen 'sprightly, slim and erect', speaking at the Congress session of 1927 in that city? The same man who, when he visited him in Allahabad ten years later, had 'jumped two steps at a time, with me emulating him, as I followed him upstairs from his office room on the ground floor to his study and library above?' The same man who, when they were both members of the Constituent Assembly of India, during one session 'impulsively ran from his front seat and literally dragged a recalcitrant member from the podium rebuking him audibly *yeh Jhansi ki public meeting nahin hai*'? [This is not a public meeting in Jhansi.] The same man on whom the nationalist poetess, Sarojini Naidu, had 'affectionately conferred the sobriquet "Jack-in-the-box"—a compliment to his restless agility of body and mind'?

Kamath was clear that it was the war with China that was responsible for this deterioration and degradation. As he wrote, 'India's defeat, nay, military debacle in that one-month war not only shattered [Nehru] physically and weakened him mentally but, what was more galling to him, eroded his prestige in Asia and the world, dealt a crippling blow to his visions of leadership of the newly emancipated nations, and cast a shadow on his place in history.'

It was, the affectionate yet critical observer insisted, a debacle that could have been avoided, had Nehru not 'stubbornly turned a deaf ear to all friendly warnings', offered, for example, by his own deputy prime minister, Vallabhbhai Patel, who, as far back as 1950, had alerted him to 'China's